1982, J.N. Dixit succeeded J.S. Teja as India's ambassador in Kabul. He arrived in Kabul on 15 January.

Sometime in August, Soviet troops conducted a major anti-insurgency operation in the Pashmool, Malajat and Sanzari areas of Kandahar province, with the help of about two hundred and fifty tanks and three hundred vehicles. According to government reports, the Afghans now had a hold over the major towns, but the rebels still dominated the rural areas. A R&AW dispatch to New Delhi noted:

The rebels were not in a position to dislodge Soviets from Afghanistan and the Soviets on their own have not shown the least intention to move out of Afghanistan in the very near future. The rebels enjoy sympathies of more than 90% of the local population who do not want the presence of Soviet troops in Afghanistan but they have not been able to channelise this discontentment properly and are frittering away their energies in inter-group fighting.

In his address on 5 September 1982 to soldiers of the 37th para-commando regiment which had returned from Panj shir, Babrak Karmal claimed that the party's programmes and policies were at last being accepted by the religious and tribal elders in areas where opposition had been most vocal. The misunderstandings created by the policies of Taraki and Amin were being clarified. Karmal also addressed a series of meetings in the presidential palace where representatives of different tribes and nationalities from all over Afghanistan were gathered. He declared that the party and the government intended to actively encourage the revival of the tribal jirgas at the district and sub-district levels to ensure the extensive participation of representatives of different tribes and